

Stay in, stay entertained



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Editor

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Consider the way our lives have changed. In just a few short years we've gone from struggling to find information to being overloaded with it. We're connected all the time, working all the time, and doing so many things with our time that we never seem to find any of it just for ourselves. Of course, the increasing stress and constant neural activity has us on edge a lot more, and thus the need to unwind increases.

Thanks to the overcrowding of cities, and the sheer physical exhaustion of the rat race, unwinding is no longer as easy as catching a flick in the local theatre, or sitting by the sea-side enjoying a cool summer breeze.

Take the theatres for instance. If you think you can show up at a theatre on a weekend, on a whim, and hope to get tickets for any movie worth watching, think again. Like everything else in life today, you have to plan your outings well in advance. Besides, even if you get tickets for that blockbuster you've been dying to see, it's not like you're guaranteed a fun time. If the traffic and war for parking spaces doesn't get to you, the other people in the theatre will. Just when the movie's getting interesting, the person next to you will get a call, proceed to answer it, and stupidly think that a 10-minute conversation being carried out less than a foot from your right ear will not disturb you. Yes blue T-shirt guy with an iPhone and the yelping dog ring tone, who sat next to me when I saw *Avatar* a few months ago, I mean you. As for sitting by the sea-side, whatever's left of it, summer breezes these days are likely to singe your eyebrows thanks to global warming, and give you whooping cough because of all the pollution and particulate matter in the air.

So what options are you left with? Stay indoors of course. Relax on your sofa, or in your bed, do things at your own pace, and find new ways to entertain yourself and the family. Thankfully, there's a big push on by the entertainment industry to help us do just that. With large screen HDTVs being pushed in your face at every electronics store, superstars of Bollywood coaxing you to get DTH services, new and improved home theatre systems, a gazillion ways to get content to your living room, affordable prices of hot, new categories like HD media players, and lest I forget the entire gaming industry and the internet, I'd say we're pretty spoilt for choices.

According to a study conducted by KPMG and FICIL, the Indian media and entertainment

industry is set to grow at over 12 per cent per annum, and cross the \$20 billion (almost Rs. 90,000 crore) mark by 2013. And you're going to experience most of that growth in your living room. Sure there's mobile entertainment and on-the-go goodness also planned, but I think we all know that our homes are going to remain the primary source of entertainment for us all.

So where does technology come in? It will be instrumental in ensuring that you get your daily dose, and making the current experience even better.

3D TV, for example, is one area where a lot of people see the next big change happening. HD broadcasts and video on demand are hot topics in the DTH space, HD media players let you use your HDTVs the way they're supposed to be used. And 4K (pg. 38) promises to outdo HD in the near future.

Like with any other technology segment, competition is fierce, and the choices you have to make are too numerous to list... That's where we come in.

Most of the topics mentioned here are in the magazine, in the form of tests of reviews, or features, to give you a better insight into what to buy, what to look forward to, and how to entertain yourself.

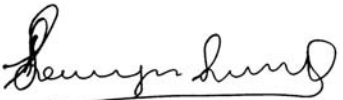
Of course it's not just about the hardware. Myriads of artists are jostling for a time share of your speakers and screen, and a lot of them are entertaining you for free.

If there's one article I want you to focus on in this issue, it's the one on page 34, because I'd like to encourage all of our readers to share their creativity with the community.

At Digit, we want to make sure that apart from everything else that we're doing, we also want to give you a voice and a platform to be heard. If you've created something, anything, and want to share it with the community, use one of our online platforms, or mail us and tell us.

Personally, I'm especially interested in artists who want to share their music and movies for free, and also those who have interesting ideas for Digit's I Think Green initiative.

Also remember to catch Digit's 9th Anniversary Special next month. Visit thinkdigit.com/ june to get more details, and also to give us your suggestions. 


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